Trump Wants to Rebuild a Public Golf Course in Washington

From: NPR World Mined: 2026-10-19 3 min read

President Donald Trump wants to rebuild East Potomac Golf Links. It is a public golf course in Washington, D.C., about 2 miles from the White House. It sits on **national park** land.

On Sunday, Trump wrote online that the course is "old, broken, **dilapidated**." He said work will start on November 15. The course will close for about 15 months. He shared a plan for a fancy new course that could hold big **tournaments**.

But there is a court case about it. In February, a group and two people **sued** the government. They say a fancy course would make it cost more to play. They say the course was meant to be "open to all people."

The government says the people suing have not shown they were harmed. A **judge**, Ana C. Reyes, told the government to stop cutting down trees at the park. Now the government wants a different **judge**.

The next court hearing is on Monday.

Word Treasure

dilapidated -- Dilapidated means old and falling apart.

tournaments -- Tournaments are big contests where many players compete to win.

national park -- A national park is land the government protects for everyone to visit and enjoy.

sued -- Sued means asked a court to decide that someone did something wrong.

judge -- A judge is the person in charge of a court who makes decisions in a case.

Background you need

Washington, D.C., is the capital city of the United States, where the White House is.

Some parks there belong to everyone and are cared for by the National Park Service.

When people disagree with a government plan, they can ask a court to decide.

Break it down

WHO: President Donald Trump, people suing the government, and Judge Ana C. Reyes
WHAT: A plan to close and rebuild East Potomac Golf Links
WHERE: National park land in Washington, D.C., about 2 miles from the White House
WHY: Trump says the course is old and broken, but others worry a fancy course would cost more to play

Why it matters

Public parks belong to everyone, so changes to them can affect families who use them.

Test what you remember

1. What does President Trump want to rebuild?

(A) A public golf course in Washington, D.C.
(B) A school in Texas
(C) A bridge in New York
(D) A zoo in California

2. How far is the golf course from the White House?

(A) About 2 miles
(B) Right next door
(C) About 15 miles
(D) About 200 miles

3. When will work start?

(A) In February
(B) Monday
(C) November 15
(D) Next summer

4. How long will the course be closed?

(A) One day
(B) About 15 months
(C) Ten years
(D) Two weeks

5. Why did some people sue?

(A) They worry a fancy course would cost more to play
(B) They want more trees cut down
(C) They do not like golf balls
(D) They want a bigger White House

6. What did Judge Ana C. Reyes tell the government to do?

(A) Stop cutting down trees at the park
(B) Close the park forever
(C) Pay for new golf clubs
(D) Build the course faster

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: C 4: B 5: A 6: A

Questions to think about

1. President Trump: He says the course is old and broken and wants a course for big tournaments.
2. People suing: They say the course was meant to be open to all people and should not cost more.
3. The government: It says the people suing have not shown they were harmed.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):